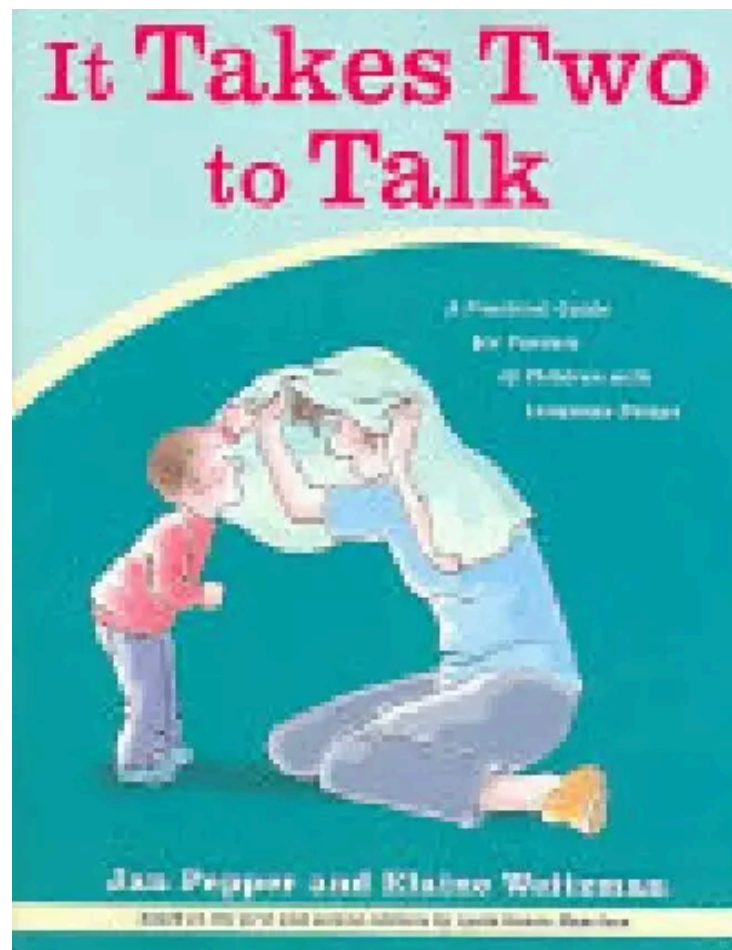


It Takes Two to Talk A Practical Guide for Parents of Children with Language Delays Jan Pepper



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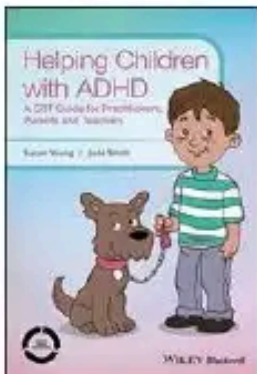
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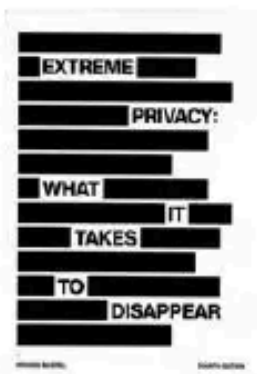
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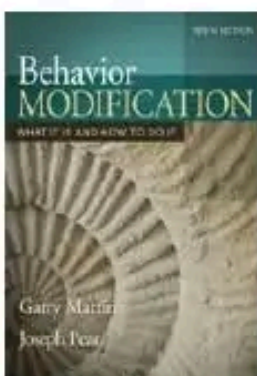
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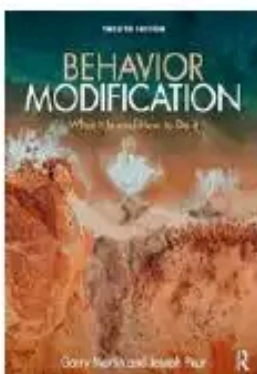
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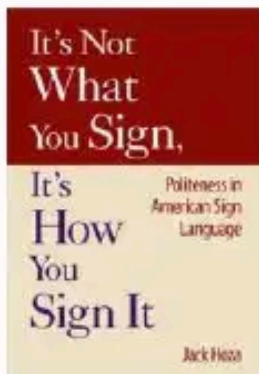
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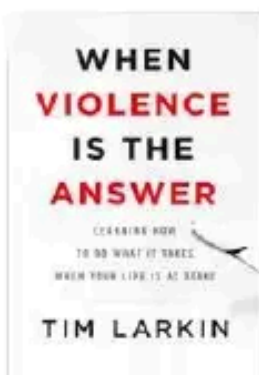
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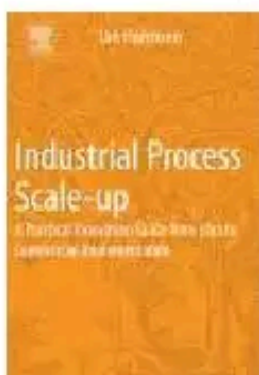
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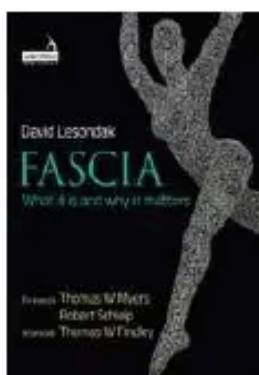
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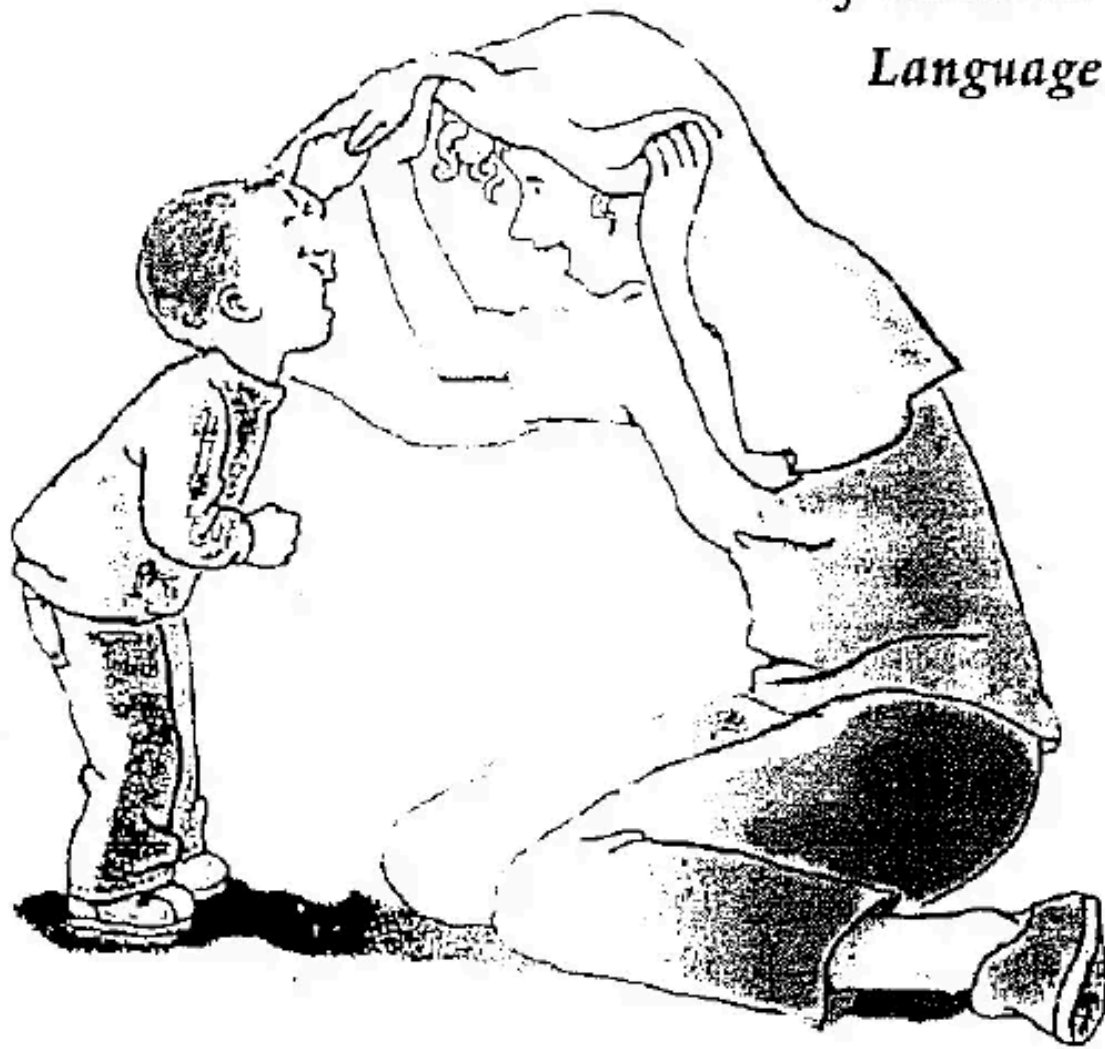


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It Takes Two to Talk

*A Practical Guide
for Parents
of Children with
Language Delays*



Jan Pepper and Elaine Weitzman

based on the first and second editions by Ayala Hanen Manolson

 The
Hanen
Program.

It Takes Two to Talk
By Jan Pepper and Elaine Weitzman



A Hanen Centre Publication

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Third Edition

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THE HANEN CENTRE

1075 Bay Street, Suite 513

Toronto, Ontario

Canada M5S 2B1

Telephone: (416) 921-1073

Fax: (416) 921-1225

E-mail: info@hanen.org

Web: www.hanen.org

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To Hanen Certified speech-language
pathologists/therapists around the world,
who make such a difference in the lives
of children with language delays and
their families. †

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Foreword

Welcome to *It Takes Two to Talk*! If you have picked up this book, you are probably thinking hard about the speech and language development of an important young child in your life. You might also be worrying about this child, wondering why he or she might not be developing communication skills at the expected rate, and how you could help him or her move forward in this area of development. You have the right book in your hands!

It Takes Two to Talk is a book for parents and caregivers of young children who need extra support in their speech and language development. It is a book that will teach you skills and strategies that you can use on a daily basis, in almost every interaction you have with your child. The book has been written by speech-language pathologists who realize that parents can, in many ways, contribute to their child's speech and language development more than the professionals. We are the constant people in our young children's lives. We are there more than the professionals. What this book does is give us the strategies the professionals use so that our children can benefit from long-term, ongoing, daily support.

Take your time with reading the book. There is so much to learn, and many of the ideas and strategies take time to practice. But as you practice them, your child will benefit. Be open to interacting with your child in new ways, observing gestures and facial expressions carefully and following his or her lead. Like many things in life, the more you put into working with the *It Takes Two to Talk* Program, the more you will get out of it, and the more your child will benefit. It is not a hard program to learn. It just takes some time and practice.

Do not feel alone in your world of having a child with delayed speech and language. This book was written because there are many, many children who, for various reasons, have delayed speech and language. This book will help you and, in turn, will help your child. It will be exciting, and it will be wonderful. Celebrate all of the small steps, because together they add up to moving forward. Your child is fortunate because you have taken the time to pick up this book and learn from it. You want to support your child, and this book is here to help you do that. Enjoy your reading and, more important, enjoy communicating with your child!

Anne Marie

It Takes Two to Talk parent

Acknowledgements

Jan Pepper would like to say ...

Ayala Hanen Manolson, the first Executive Director of The Hanen Centre and author of this book's earlier editions, had the wisdom to see the importance of involving parents when she founded The Hanen Centre in 1977. Her creativity started a legacy that has helped thousands of children, families and speech-language professionals around the world.

I owe my greatest thanks to the families I have worked with over the years. This book is for parents, whose devotion is a constant source of inspiration, and for children who face the challenge of communicating when it doesn't come easily. It is for you that I wanted this book to be everything it could be.

My colleagues at The Hanen Centre make it a pleasure to come to work every day. I would especially like to thank Cindy Conklin, Cindy Earle, Janice Greenberg, Michelle Lintott, Cheri Rorabeck, Sandra Strachan and Fern Sussman for their ideas and support throughout this project. I would also like to thank Penny Tantakis and Stacie Scherer for their creative work in design and production. Behind the words in this book is a talented group of Hanen Instructors who bring *It Takes Two to Talk* to life all over the world by training and inspiring speech-language pathologists. Thank you for so generously sharing your ideas, reviewing chapter drafts and providing feedback. I am grateful to Barb Wyde and the speech-language pathologists with the south quadrant of Toronto Preschool Speech and Language Services and to Diana Ingrosso and Bonnie Stewart of Early Words in Hamilton, Ontario, for their time and suggestions.

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There is much more to writing a book than putting words on paper. Martin Townsend is a gifted editor who took our words and made them sound better without changing what we wanted to say. Pat Cupples made the words come to life in her delightful illustrations, which serve as "visual helpers" throughout this book. I would also like to thank Linda Gustafson at Counterpunch for her thoughtfulness, patience and eye for detail in the design of this book.

I would like to thank my family for giving me such a wonderful example of how every child can thrive when surrounded by people who love and care for her. Mom shared her love of learning. Thank you for persuading me to "look it up in the dictionary." Dad encouraged me to make life an adventure and never stop seeing the wonder of the world.

It is difficult to find words to adequately express thanks to my friends for their constant support, love and encouragement over the years. Their children – a whole new generation of friends – have provided a source of joy and laughter

in my life and have given me the opportunity to see the world through the eyes of a child. In many different ways, they are an important part of this book.

Finally, a heartfelt thank you to Maddie, Lee-Ann and James for their important contribution to *It Takes Two to Talk*.

Elaine Weitzman would like to say ...

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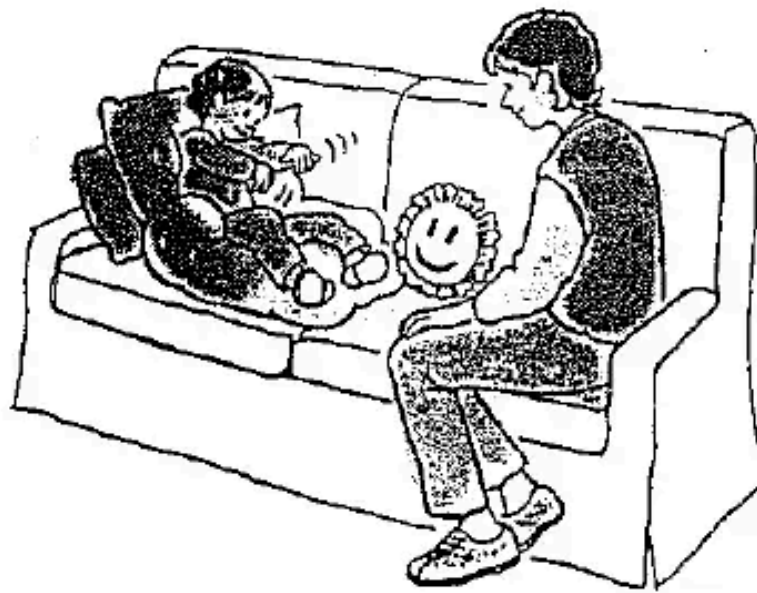
Special thanks go to three good friends, who are also talented clinicians and wonderful colleagues. Fern Sussman and Cindy Earle provided invaluable input into Chapter 7 at a time when they were both immersed in other projects. Anne McDade, Hanen UK/Ireland Representative and Hanen Instructor, came up with the SPARK acronym all the way from Scotland (thank goodness for instant messaging and e-mail) and was always available to provide input at a moment's notice, in spite of the time difference.

The Hanen Centre is fortunate to have the support and guidance of a committed Board of Directors. Many thanks to Jim Wooder, Chairman, Edmund Clarke, Frank Copping, Liz Milne, Juli Marrow and Derek Nelson for their ongoing interest in and commitment to our growing organization.

Thanks go to my wonderful family. My mother, who was the model of a career woman long before her time, has always encouraged me and continues to take an active interest in whatever I do. My sisters, Adele and Margie, are a source of ongoing support and always provide welcome comic relief.

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Learn More About Your Child's Communication



These children all have something important to say, but they can't express themselves as well or as easily as other children their age. Perhaps you have something in common with the parents of these children. Like them, you want what's best for your child. You want to help your child communicate. If you are the parent or caregiver of a child whose speech and language are not developing as expected, *It Takes Two to Talk* is for you.

You've Already Started

Children don't learn to talk all by themselves. They learn to communicate gradually as they spend time with the important people in their lives, especially their parents. You and your child have been communicating since he was born. Through this communication you've developed a strong connection. To help him become the best communicator he can be, you just need to build on the connection you already have.

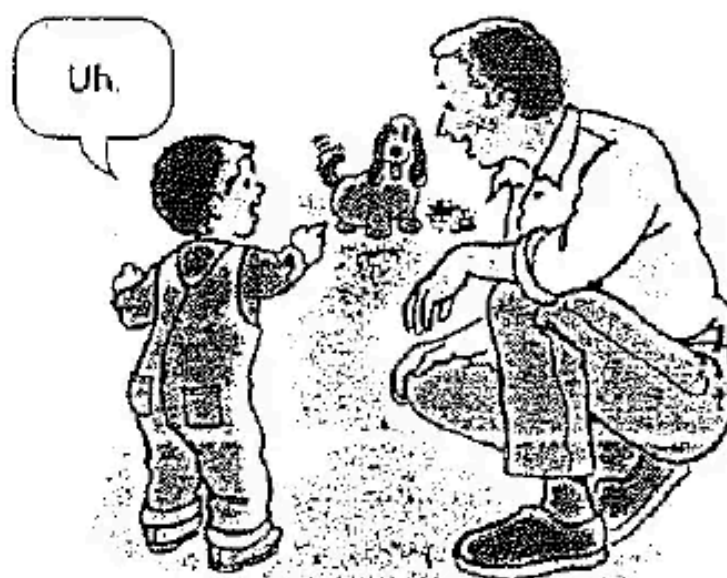
By reading *It Takes Two to Talk*, you'll learn simple but powerful strategies for helping your child communicate to the best of his ability. You'll find that everyday situations like getting him dressed or putting him to bed are ideal times to use these strategies. What's more, you'll see that building communication into your child's everyday life won't be hard work or stressful – for your child or for you. In fact, it will become a natural part of the time you spend together.

How and Why Children Communicate

Communication isn't just about talking. Whenever two people send messages of any kind to each other – even without words – they are communicating. Babies communicate long before they start to talk – by crying, making sounds, moving their bodies or reaching for something. As children grow, they let you know what's on their minds in other ways, such as through gestures, speech and signs. Learning more about how your child communicates is the first step toward helping him become a better communicator.



HOW Colin communicates with his mom: by looking at her, smiling and wiggling his arms and legs.

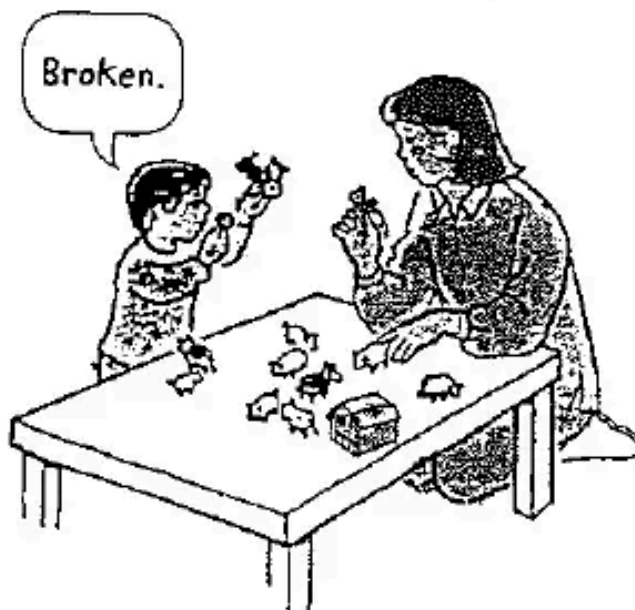


HOW Brian communicates with his dad: he looks, points and makes a sound.

Becoming aware of how your child communicates is important, but you also need to think about why he communicates. Even before they use words, children communicate for many different reasons: to tell you what they want or don't want, to get your attention, to ask questions or to make comments. As their communication develops, they get better at letting you know what's on their minds and what's important to them.



*WHY Alicia communicates:
to ask her mom a question.*



*WHY Graham communicates: to make a
comment about his tractor.*



*WHY Adam communicates: to tell his
dad he doesn't want something.*

Signs and pictures

When children understand what words mean but are having a hard time learning to talk, they can learn to communicate by making signs or pointing to pictures instead. Throughout this book, you'll read more about how signs and pictures can help children learn language. A speech-language professional can help you decide whether this approach could benefit your child.

Learning more about how and why your child communicates will help you see and hear the messages he sends you – even the ones that aren't so obvious. The following lists describe **how** and **why** children communicate. Circle or highlight the hows and whys you notice in your child.

HOW My Child Communicates:

★ Cries or screams ★ Smiles ★ Moves his body (kicks, wiggles)
 ★ Changes his facial expression ★ Makes sounds ★ Reaches
 ★ Looks at me or at what he wants ★ Points ★ Imitates sounds
 ★ Looks at what he wants and then at me ★ Takes me by the hand to what he wants ★ Uses gestures, such as waving for bye-bye ★ Uses sounds that stand for words ★ Uses single words or signs ★ Combines two or more words at a time

WHY My Child Communicates:

★ Because he is hungry or tired ★ Because he is happy ★ To respond to something interesting, such as my voice ★ To protest or refuse something ★ To get attention ★ To request something ★ To show me something he is interested in ★ To greet or say goodbye ★ To show off
 ★ To follow directions ★ To answer questions ★ To tell someone about something (comment) ★ To ask a question

Your Child's Stage of Communication

Every child's ability to communicate develops gradually over time. In *It Takes Two to Talk*, we divide the early years of this development into four major stages:

- **Discoverers** react to how they feel and to what is happening around them, but do not communicate with a specific purpose in mind.
- **Communicators** send specific messages without using words.
- **First Words Users** use single words (or signs or pictures).
- **Combiners** combine words into sentences of two or three words.

Children with communication difficulties progress through the same stages as other children, but more slowly (although some children may not get through all the stages).

As you read the descriptions of the four stages below, think about which one best describes how and why your child is currently communicating.

Discoverer

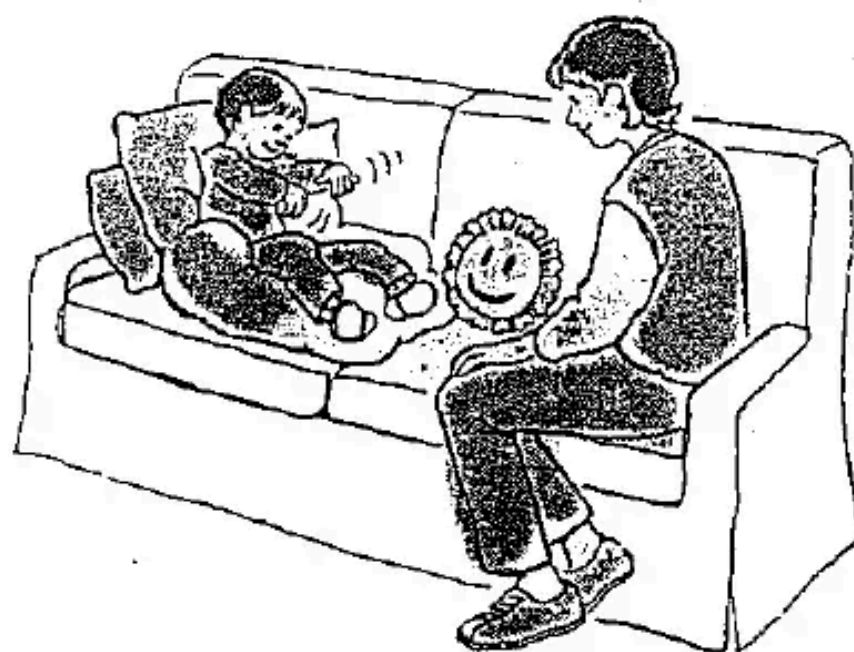
How the Discoverer Expresses Himself:

The Discoverer is in the earliest stage of learning to communicate. He does not yet communicate deliberately (with a specific purpose in mind). He just reacts to how he is feeling and to what is happening around him. In the beginning, crying is the best way a Discoverer has to let you know that he needs something, such as food, sleep or to be picked up. Over time his cries change, and a "hungry cry" sounds different from a "tired cry."

The Discoverer also communicates through facial expressions and body movements. He may turn away if he doesn't want something. If there's too much going on, he may close his eyes. Soon, the Discoverer learns to stop moving so that he can pay attention to new and interesting sights, sensations and sounds, including the sound of your voice. He becomes interested in others and expresses this interest by looking, smiling or making sounds. Later on, the Discoverer begins to explore his world more. He reaches for objects or people, or moves toward them. Parents have to pay close attention to learn what a Discoverer is interested in.

The Discoverer begins to use his voice in different ways. The first sounds that he makes are sounds like "eeee" and "aaah." Later, these change to sounds like "coo" and "goo." This is called cooing. Toward the end of the stage, the Discoverer puts together strings of sounds like "bah-bah-bah-bah." This is called babbling.

The Discoverer also changes the loudness and tone of his voice. He may make happy sounds when you talk or sing to him. He also imitates some of the sounds you make, as well as some of your actions and facial expressions. The Discoverer looks, smiles, laughs and makes sounds to get and keep your attention. You can tell that he enjoys interacting with you.



From watching the way Jordan looks at his smiley-face pillow, his mom can tell that he really likes it.

What the Discoverer Understands: The Discoverer doesn't yet understand words, but he's becoming more aware of the world around him. He is starting to recognize some faces, objects, voices and sounds. He turns his head toward some sounds and voices, especially Mom's or Dad's. He is easily startled by sudden changes, such as loud noises or fast movements.



Tolln is startled by the noise of a book falling on the floor.

The Discoverer smiles back at a face that is smiling at him. He watches your face when you talk to him. An older Discoverer stops moving when he hears you call his name and also starts to understand simple gestures. For example, when you hold your arms out, he may lift his arms to be picked up. Although the Discoverer doesn't yet understand your words, he responds to the tone of your voice and to familiar situations. Over time, he begins to

anticipate what happens next in daily routines like meals or bath time. For example, when you're getting him ready for his bath and he hears the water running, he may squeal or kick his legs because he's looking forward to splashing in the tub. Because he can anticipate, the Discoverer also enjoys games like Peekaboo and Tickle.

Communicator

When you consistently respond to your child's messages, gradually he makes the exciting and powerful connection that what he does has an effect on those around him. He now understands that he can make things happen. For example, he realizes that when he holds his arms up, you pick him up, and when he makes a sound, you pay attention to him. Reaching this new understanding of the world is called making the communication connection. When your child makes the communication connection, he becomes a Communicator.

How the Communicator Expresses Himself: The Communicator begins to send messages with a specific purpose in mind. Even though he isn't using words yet, he communicates with you by looking at you, making gestures, pointing and making sounds. At first, he communicates to protest or refuse something he doesn't want. He'll also let you know that he wants an object – a toy, for instance – or that he wants you to do something, like take him out of his high chair.

Later on, the Communicator becomes more social in his communication, sharing his interests with you. He communicates to get your attention, to say hello or goodbye, or to show you something. Often he'll point to tell you about something. He may also make sounds in a questioning tone of voice to ask questions. As he gets better and better at communicating with you, he may even make up his own gestures. For example, if he rubs his face with the back of his hand, he may be communicating about his special blanket.

The Communicator may keep trying to get his message across until you respond the way he wants. For example, if he reaches and makes sounds to ask for a cracker and you hand him a cracker, he may become quiet. He may also smile to let you know that's what he wants. But if he wants a cracker and you hand him a drink, he'll often let you know that's not what he wants. He might appear quite frustrated, raising his voice. He may take your hand to show you exactly what he wants. Succeeding at making himself understood is an important part of his communication development.

Another important part of his development happens when he learns to focus on a person and an object at the same time. Previously, your child could focus on either you or an object, but not both together. At the Communicator stage he looks at an object and points to it, and then he looks at you. Then he looks back and points to the object again, to make sure you know what he's communicating about. This new skill makes it possible for him to show you things and let you know what he thinks about them. This is one of the most important steps on the way to using first words or signs.



Miguel, a Communicator, uses a gesture to tell his mom that he can't find his bear.



Robert lets his grandmother know what's on his mind by pointing to the apple while looking first at her and then back at the apple.

